# Gabriel / Chosen

Current company version · generated from the structured master script

## CHOSEN: THE STORY BEFORE THE MANGER

## SCENE 3 — GABRIEL / CHOSEN

### CONTINUOUS FROM SCENE 2

*Joseph has just exited.*

**JOSEPH**
Tomorrow?

**MARY**
Tomorrow.

*Joseph disappears.*

*Mary remains alone.*

*For several seconds, nothing happens.*

*Let the audience stay with her happiness.*

*Mary looks toward the place Joseph exited.*

*She smiles.*

*She begins quietly putting things in order.*

*Perhaps she*

*folds a piece of cloth;*

*straightens the unfinished table piece Joseph showed her;*

*moves one of the chairs;*

*touches the wood and imagines the future they were just discussing.*

*She catches herself smiling.*

**MARY**
Eight chairs.

*She shakes her head.*

**MARY**
Joseph...

*Small laugh.*

*She resumes folding.*

## THE INTERRUPTION

*The distant sounds of Nazareth are still present.*

*A voice.*

*A cart.*

*A child somewhere outside.*

*A faint hammer.*

*Then—*

*everything stops.*

*Not slowly.*

*Gone.*

*Mary notices.*

*She waits.*

**MARY**
Hello?

*Nothing.*

*She listens.*

**MARY**
Is someone there?

*A subtle musical texture enters.*

*Something completely different from the musical language of Nazareth.*

*Not loud.*

*Not threatening.*

*Unfamiliar.*

*The light begins changing.*

*Mary turns.*

*She sees GABRIEL.*

*Gabriel does not rush toward her.*

*Stillness is part of the power of the moment.*

**GABRIEL**
Mary.

*Mary steps backward.*

**MARY**
Who are you?

**GABRIEL**
Do not be afraid.

**MARY**
I wasn't—

*She stops.*

**MARY**
I… ok, wait…

*Mary stops and backs away*

*Gabriel remains calm.*

**GABRIEL**
You have found favor with God.

*Gabriel walks towards Mary*

**MARY**
Favor?

*Still walks away from Gabriel slowly*

**GABRIEL**
Yes.

*Continues walking towards Mary*

**MARY**
I don't understand.

*Still walks backwards away from Gabriel*

**GABRIEL**
You will.

*Continues walking towards Mary*

*Beat.*

**MARY**
Who are you?

*Still walks backwards away from Gabriel*

**GABRIEL**
Gabriel.

*A beat.*

*Stops walking and stands still*

**GABRIEL**
I have been sent by God.

*Mary stops, she absorbs that.*

*She looks toward the doorway, as though part of her still expects someone else to walk in and make this ordinary again.*

*No one does.*

## THE CALLING

**GABRIEL**
Mary...

you have been chosen.

*Mary looks at him.*

**MARY**
Chosen for what?

**GABRIEL**
You will bear a son.

*Silence.*

*Mary does not respond.*

**MARY**
I'm sorry—

what did you say?

**GABRIEL**
You will bear a son.

**MARY**
No.

*Not rejection.*

*Her mind simply cannot make the words fit.*

**MARY**
I mean—

how?

*Beat.*

**MARY**
How can that be?

**GABRIEL**
What will happen comes from God.

**MARY**
I understand the words.

*Beat.*

**MARY**
I don't understand how they can be true.

**GABRIEL**
Nothing God has spoken is beyond His power.

*Mary looks at him carefully.*

**MARY**
Why me?

**GABRIEL**
Because God has chosen you.

**MARY**
That doesn't answer the question.

*Gabriel regards her.*

*Not offended.*

**GABRIEL**
It may be the only answer you are given tonight.

*That lands.*

## MARY SEARCHES FOR CERTAINTY

**MARY**
You expect me to believe this?

**GABRIEL**
I expect you to decide whether you will trust the One who sent me.

**MARY**
Those aren't the same thing.

**GABRIEL**
No.

*They are not.*

*Mary studies him.*

*That answer surprises her.*

**MARY**
What happens now?

**GABRIEL**
You live the answer.

**MARY**
That's all?

**GABRIEL**
No.

*Beat.*

**GABRIEL**
Your relative Elizabeth is also expecting a child.

*Mary looks up.*

**MARY**
Elizabeth?

**GABRIEL**
Yes.

**MARY**
But she—

*Mary stops herself.*

*She knows what she was going to say.*

**GABRIEL**
What seemed impossible...

is already happening.

*Mary takes that in.*

*This is the first piece of the message she can attach to something in her world.*

**MARY**
Elizabeth.

**GABRIEL**
Go to her if you need to see what God has already begun.

## THE COST ARRIVES

*Mary looks toward the unfinished table.*

*The future from Scene 2 is sitting in front of her.*

*The house.*

*The table.*

*The marriage.*

*Joseph.*

*Her breathing changes slightly.*

**MARY**
What will people think?

*Gabriel does not answer immediately.*

**MARY**
My family?

The village?

*Still no false reassurance.*

**MARY**
Joseph...

*That name lands hardest.*

**MARY**
What am I supposed to tell Joseph?

**GABRIEL**
The truth.

**MARY**
And if the truth sounds impossible?

**GABRIEL**
It will still be the truth.

**MARY**
That doesn't mean he'll believe me.

**GABRIEL**
No.

*Mary looks at Gabriel.*

*That is not the answer she wanted.*

**MARY**
You don't know Joseph.

**GABRIEL**
God does.

**MARY**
He has plans.

*Her eyes move back to the table.*

**MARY**
We have plans.

A home.

A wedding.

A family.

*Beat.*

**MARY**
He thinks he knows how our life is supposed to go.

**GABRIEL**
And you?

*Mary looks at him.*

**MARY**
Until a moment ago...

so did I.

**MUSICAL TRIGGER — “CHOSEN”**

*The first musical phrase begins.*

*Not triumph.*

*Not celebration.*

*A question.*

*Gabriel does not suddenly disappear.*

*He remains present, but the focus begins transferring to Mary.*

**The song begins because she has finally understood**

*This miracle has a cost.*

*“CHOSEN”*

**[VERSE 1]**

I knew the road to the well,

I knew the shape of the day,

I knew the life I was promised

Would not be taken away.

*BLOCKING: Mary stays where the dialogue leaves her, near the unfinished table. Do not move into a new “song position.”*

I knew the voice of my mother,

I knew the work of my hands,

I knew the quiet kind of future

A girl like me could plan.

*BLOCKING: On “the future,” touch or straighten the unfinished table. Let it represent the home, marriage, and life Mary expected. Gabriel stays grounded and mostly still.*

Then the air begins to tremble,

Then the light begins to rise,

And a messenger of heaven

Is standing before my eyes.

*BLOCKING: Mary looks back to Gabriel. The room she knows now feels unfamiliar. Gabriel does not chase or circle her.*

**[PRE-CHORUS 1]**

And I want to run,

I want to hide,

*BLOCKING: Mary takes one instinctive step toward the exit or away from Gabriel, then stops herself.*

But somehow Your voice

Is already inside.

*BLOCKING: Mary turns back toward Gabriel. Keep the movement simple.*

**[CHORUS 1]**

Chosen,

Not ready, not strong,

I don’t know where this road will lead,

But I hear You calling.

*BLOCKING: Mary moves only slightly downstage into open space. She is testing the word “chosen,” not celebrating it.*

Chosen,

Can that be my name?

Can heaven ask these hands of mine

To hold what I can’t name?

*BLOCKING: On “these hands of mine,” one brief look at her hands is enough.*

I am afraid,

But I am listening.

Could I be chosen?

*BLOCKING: Stop moving. Let the question hang.*

**[VERSE 2]**

What will Joseph see

When he looks into my eyes?

Will he hear the truth in me,

Or only hear the lies?

*BLOCKING: Mary moves toward the place Joseph exited, but does not leave.*

What will the village say

When the whispers start to grow?

How do I carry heaven

When no one else can know?

*BLOCKING: Become aware of the village outside the room. Do not mime people gossiping.*

I thought faith was something steady,

Like a lamp beside the door.

Now it feels like stepping forward

Where there is no floor.

*BLOCKING: Mary shifts her weight forward and begins the idea of a step, but stops before fully taking it. She wants to move, but fear still holds her.*

**[PRE-CHORUS 2]**

How can this be?

How can this be?

I am small,

But still You see me.

*BLOCKING: Stay grounded. Let the questions work on Mary instead of adding more movement.*

**[CHORUS 2]**

Chosen,

Not ready, not strong,

I don’t know what this yes will cost,

But I hear You calling.

*BLOCKING: On “what this yes will cost,” look back at the unfinished table, but do not return to it.*

Chosen,

Is this why You came?

Can mercy ask a life like mine

To never be the same?

I am afraid,

But I am still listening.

Could I be chosen?

*BLOCKING: Mary is still frightened, but she no longer retreats.*

**[BRIDGE]**

I give You the wedding.

I give You the name.

I give You the future

I had already claimed.

*BLOCKING: Mary returns to the unfinished table. Place the cloth or simple object she has been holding onto the table.*

I give You the questions.

I give You the cost.

I give You the life

I thought was my own.

*BLOCKING: Remove her hand from the table. This is a quiet release, not a dramatic gesture.*

If faith is one step

Before the road is shown,

Then I will take it trembling,

But I will not walk alone.

*BLOCKING: Mary now completes the step she could not take earlier. One deliberate step forward. She still cannot see the road, but now she chooses to move.*

**[FINAL CHORUS]**

Chosen,

Not because I understand.

Chosen,

Not because I know the plan.

*BLOCKING: Mary becomes steady, not triumphant. Use very little movement.*

But if You are the One who calls me,

I will trust the One who knows.

Let the world misunderstand me,

Still my answer will be Yours.

*BLOCKING: On “Let the world misunderstand me,” briefly acknowledge the village outside. On “Still my answer will be Yours,” return focus to Gabriel.*

I am afraid,

But I am willing.

I am Yours.

I am chosen.

*BLOCKING: Hold still on “But I am willing.” This is the emotional peak. No heroic pose or giant finish.*

**[TAG]**

Let it be as You have spoken.

I am Yours.

I am chosen.

*BLOCKING: Let the music settle. No victory pose. In the song, Mary makes the decision privately within herself. The spoken acceptance that follows is when she gives that decision to Gabriel — her final “yes.”*

**THE MUSIC APPROACHES ITS FINAL RESOLUTION**

*Mary turns toward Gabriel.*

*The music holds.*

*Then—*

*nearly stops.*

*Silence.*

*Mary breathes.*

*She is still afraid.*

*That matters.*

**MARY**
I don't understand what comes next.

**GABRIEL**
I know.

**MARY**
And I'm afraid.

**GABRIEL**
I know.

*Beat.*

**MARY**
But if God has asked this of me...

*She gathers herself.*

**MARY**
I am the Lord's servant.

*Beat.*

**MARY**
Let it be with me as He has said.

*Silence.*

*No instant explosion of music.*

*No triumphant celebration.*

*Let the decision stand by itself.*

*Gabriel regards her.*

*For the first time, there may be something almost tender in his expression.*

**GABRIEL**
Do not be afraid, Mary.

*Mary takes a breath.*

**MARY**
I'm trying.

**GABRIEL**
That is enough for tonight.

## GABRIEL DEPARTS

*The light around Gabriel begins to change.*

*Do not make his departure a magic trick simply for spectacle.*

*It can be*

*a controlled fade;*

*a shift in light;*

*Gabriel moving into darkness;*

*Mary's attention being pulled briefly elsewhere and finding him gone.*

*The divine musical texture recedes.*

*Mary is alone again.*

*Same room.*

*Same wood.*

*Same cloth.*

*Same unfinished table.*

*Nothing looks different.*

*Everything is different.*

### FINAL MOMENT

*Mary stands quietly.*

*She touches the unfinished table.*

*A faint fragment of “My Beloved” is heard.*

*Perhaps only a few notes.*

*Mary remembers*

> *“Whatever comes, I'll walk with you.”*

*Her expression changes.*

*Not because she regrets saying yes.*

*Because now she understands what she has to do next.*

*She looks toward the direction Joseph left.*

**MARY**

Joseph...

**NEAR-BLACK TRANSITION INTO SCENE 4: Hold a narrow special on Mary after “Joseph...” for one breath. Fade the surrounding stage and LED to deep blue near-black. Keep Mary's side exit path safely lit as she leaves. The unfinished table stays in place; the friends' small work props are preset. No furniture moves in darkness. Bring up ordinary daylight on the friends' work area.**

**END SCENE 3**